HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Friendliness usually hides an ulterior motive."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "Friendliness usually hides an ulterior motive." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when suspicion appears.

- ☐ What did this person actually say or do?
- ☐ What evidence suggests an ulterior motive? What evidence does not?
- ☐ Could ordinary kindness explain the same behavior?
- ☐ Am I judging this person by someone else's past actions?
- ☐ Has this person respected a boundary or accepted a 'no'?
- ☐ What would a balanced, cautious interpretation sound like?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ Kindness may be genuine; I can look at the evidence.
- ☐ I do not have to know someone's motives immediately.
- ☐ I can be friendly while keeping sensible boundaries.
- ☐ A compliment does not automatically create an obligation.
- ☐ I can wait for patterns of behavior before deciding.
- ☐ God calls me to wisdom, not constant suspicion.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Proverbs 3:5–6
  "Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding; in all your ways acknowledge Him, and He will make your paths straight."
- ☐ 1 Corinthians 13:7
  "It bears all things, believes all things, hopes all things, endures all things."
- ☐ Philippians 4:8
  "Finally, brothers, whatever is true, whatever is honorable, whatever is right, whatever is pure, whatever is lovely, whatever is admirable—if anything is excellent or praiseworthy—think on these things."

- [ ] James 1:19
  “My beloved brothers, understand this: Everyone should be quick to listen, slow to speak, and slow to anger,”
- [ ] Proverbs 18:13
  “He who answers a matter before he hears it—this is folly and disgrace to him.”

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Trust. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ When a familiar person offers a small courtesy, say thank you without trying to guess their motive. Later, note what actually happened.
- ☐ Accept a minor, no-strings-attached kindness from someone with a history of respecting your boundaries. Record whether a demand followed.
- ☐ Offer a small kindness to another person with no expectation of repayment. Reflect on how kindness can be genuine.
- ☐ For one week, record both examples of sincere kindness and examples of self-interest. Compare the whole pattern.
- ☐ When someone compliments you, write down three possible explanations—including a sincere one—before deciding.
- ☐ Set a polite boundary ('No, thank you') and notice whether the person respects it. Do not test someone who has been unsafe.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about trusting God and treating people fairly.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~Friendliness usually hides an ulterior motive.~~

NEW TRUTH:
I can recognize genuine kindness through evidence and time, while keeping healthy boundaries.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Proverbs 3:5–6

A short prayer

Lord, help me notice what is true instead of assuming what others intend. Give me wisdom to recognize danger, courage to receive sincere kindness, and love that does not rush to judge. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.